MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 1, Episode 3

"The Bridge Rule"

Episode 1x03. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 1x03. Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Sunday, July 17, 2005, 5:41 AM through Monday, July 18, 2005, 12:48 PM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 45 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-1x02

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on July 1, 2005). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Sunday, July 17, 2005)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	26
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (9 weeks pregnant)	Aug 29, 1977	27
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	25
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern	Feb 10, 1979	26
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	25
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern	Oct 25, 1979	25
Curtis Roberts (new)	Rider; MTA signal maintainer	Aug 30, 1960	44
Nia Roberts (new)	Rider, age 12; Curtis's daughter	Feb 9, 1993	12
Wallace Hightower (new)	Rider; Deacon; Jehovah's Witness	Jan 12, 1938	67
DeMarco Whitley (new)	Rider; Olympic hopeful	Nov 21, 1973	31
Darnell Hicks (new)	Rider, age 19	May 1, 1986	19
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Raymond 'Big Ray' Toles	Chief of Security	Jan 1, 1960	45
Lt. Tanisha 'Tee' Rollins	FDNY EMS Lieutenant (debut)	Aug 16, 1976	28
Andre Fontaine	FDNY Paramedic (debut)	Feb 25, 1978	27
Dr. Leland Graves	Chief of Neurosurgery	Apr 18, 1953	52
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Kevin Amos (new)	Rider: tension pneumothorax	Apr 4, 1981	24
Dr. Terrell Boyce (new)	Orthopedic Resident	Sep 9, 1971	33
Yolanda Roberts (new)	Curtis's wife	Mar 15, 1965	40
Pamela Gaither-Hall (new)	NY Organ Donor Network	Feb 2, 1961	44
Anthony Hightower (new)	Wallace's son	Oct 2, 1969	35
Rose Hicks (new)	Darnell's grandmother; sickle cell	Mar 22, 1934	71
Nurse Kendra Wallace	Surgical Floor Nurse	May 30, 1980	25

Also appearing: a ride official, two angry riders, an EMS dispatcher (V.O.), an NY1 reporter (on TV), a perfusionist, an organ recovery team and coordinator, and a 49th Avenue neighbor.

Black don't crack (C-018): every regular reads several years younger than their age on screen. The ages above are exact and binding.

COLD OPEN

1 EXT. QUEENSBORO BRIDGE - DAWN
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 5:41 AM

The great steel cantilevers of the Queensboro Bridge, black against a pink sky. The lower roadway is closed to traffic. Orange cones, a banner stretched across the Queens-side approach: "QUEENS CENTURY FOR THE CURE: 100 MILES FOR SICKLE CELL. 2ND ANNUAL." Volunteers in neon vests set up water tables.

MARC (V.O.)
Every hospital in New York has a bridge it belongs to. Queens Grace got the Queensboro in 1909.

MARC (V.O.)
Since then, the rule has been simple. Whatever goes wrong on that bridge comes to us first.

2 INT. OLD MAIN - RESIDENTS' LOUNGE - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 5:48 AM

Sunday-morning quiet. The Board is half empty. ELXA BULLOCK (27) sits at the table with a sleeve of saltines and a ginger ale, trying to look like a person who chose saltines for fun. Her interns trickle in: MARC (26), AMOND (26), ESTHER (25), HARMONY (26), RAVEN (25). ARIANNA (25) sprawls on the couch, on loan again.

RAVEN
Saltines?

ELXA
Breakfast of champions.

RAVEN
My grandma eats saltines when she's...

ELXA
(instantly)
When she's a woman with a sensitive stomach who doesn't want to discuss it.

Marc looks at Elxa. She doesn't look back at him.

ELXA
Census is low. Two post-ops, a cellulitis, and a man in 412 who swallowed a fork on a dare. Sundays are always...

ARIANNA
(sitting bolt upright)
Don't.

HARMONY
Don't say it.

AMOND
Do not say the Q word.

ELXA
(beat)
...pleasant.

ARIANNA
She was going to say quiet.

ELXA
I said pleasant.

ARIANNA
The universe heard "quiet."

Elxa eats a saltine at her, aggressively.

3 EXT. QUEENS PLAZA - RIDE STAGING AREA - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 6:52 AM

Under the elevated tracks, more than four hundred CYCLISTS in yellow charity jerseys mill around, clicking into pedals, stretching, taking pictures with disposable cameras.

CURTIS ROBERTS (44), a broad, gentle MTA signal maintainer, adjusts the helmet strap on his daughter, NIA ROBERTS (12), who has braces and her father's grin. They wear matching jerseys. Hers reads "NIA, MILE 25 RIDER." His reads "CURTIS, 100 MILES FOR AUNTIE BEA."

CURTIS
Twenty-five miles. Then the van picks you up and you cheer for me at the finish.

NIA
I could do fifty.

CURTIS
You could do fifty next year. This year you do twenty-five and you tell your mama I didn't let you do fifty.

NIA
She's in Philly. She won't know.

CURTIS
(grinning)
Your mama knows everything. She's got satellites.

Nearby, DEACON WALLACE HIGHTOWER (67), lean and tough in an old-school wool cycling cap, does deep knee bends among riders a third his age. A Watchtower magazine pokes out of his saddlebag.

Nearby, DEMARCO WHITLEY (31), a sculpted pro-level cyclist in a sponsor's kit, signs a kid's jersey. A RIDE OFFICIAL with a bullhorn walks by.

RIDE OFFICIAL
Lead group in five! Whitley up front, he's pacing! Lower roadway, mind the expansion joints on the Manhattan side!

At the very back, DARNELL HICKS (19), skinny, on a borrowed bike that's a size too big, wearing sneakers instead of cycling shoes, tapes a photo of an old woman to his handlebars. "FOR GRANDMA ROSE."

4 INT. OLD MAIN - CHIEF OF SURGERY'S OFFICE - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 7:38 AM

NATASHA (47), in a Sunday cardigan, coffee in hand, behind her desk. Elxa stands at the door with her arms crossed, already defensive.

NATASHA
You're nine weeks.

ELXA
I know how far along I am. I'm a doctor.

NATASHA
You're nine weeks, and you're on a thirty-hour call, eating saltines in the residents' lounge like nobody's going to notice.

ELXA
Nobody noticed.

NATASHA
Your brother noticed. Raven Ellison almost noticed. (beat) Elxa. You can tell the program director. There are accommodations. Lighter call.

ELXA
No.

NATASHA
Baby...

ELXA
Mom. You had me in college. You had Marc during your senior thesis. You had Grace in your first year of med school. Did you ask for accommodations?

NATASHA
(quietly)
There weren't any to ask for.

ELXA
Then I don't need them either. (beat) Don't tell anybody. Not yet. Not Marc. I'll tell him when I'm ready.

NATASHA
He's going to be hurt.

ELXA
He's going to be loud. I can't take loud yet.

5 EXT. QUEENSBORO BRIDGE - LOWER ROADWAY - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 8:42 AM

Mid-span. The pack of riders flows across the bridge like a yellow river, the skyline rising ahead of them on the Manhattan side.

Nia rides in a cluster near her father, standing on her pedals, laughing. Her front wheel hits a raised steel EXPANSION JOINT at a bad angle. The wheel jerks sideways. She wobbles...

Right behind her, Darnell sees it. He swerves hard to miss her...

...and his oversized bike goes down at speed, sliding sideways across the lane.

The rider behind him hits him. Then the next. Then the next. A chain reaction ripples backward through the pack: bikes flipping, bodies hitting steel, the shriek of metal on metal.

Curtis, three bikes back, sees his daughter wobble. He brakes too hard, flies over his handlebars and lands headfirst against a steel guardrail post with a sound that silences everything.

Nia rights her bike, stops, turns around... and screams.

NIA
DADDY!

SMASH TO:

MAIN TITLE: MERCY'S ANATOMY

ACT ONE

6 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - CENTRAL STATION - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 8:51 AM

NURSE GLORIA PETTIFORD (53) is on the EMS radio, writing fast on a whiteboard. The Pit staff are already moving.

EMS DISPATCH (V.O.)
(crackling)
...multi-casualty incident, Queensboro Bridge, lower roadway, charity bicycle event. Estimate forty-plus injured. Multiple critical. Queens Grace, how many can you take?

GLORIA
(into the radio)
Queens Grace will take everything you've got. It's our bridge.

She slams the radio down and hits the overhead PA.

GLORIA
(over the PA)
Attention all staff. Code Triage. Code Triage. External mass casualty. All available surgical staff to the Pit.

Natasha comes through the doors with her coffee still in her hand. Her cardigan is gone. She's in a white coat now, every inch the Chief.

NATASHA
Gloria, how many?

GLORIA
Forty, maybe more. They're sending the reds first.

NATASHA
Open the overflow in the Pell lobby. Call in the off-duty ORs. I want every resident and every intern standing in that ambulance bay in four minutes. And somebody find Robert Bullock.

GLORIA
He's already here. He came in for a valve.

NATASHA
Then he's about to have a much longer day.

Big Ray Toles hurries past, radio to his mouth.

BIG RAY
(into the radio)
Lock the Jackson Avenue doors. EMS only through the bay.

7 EXT. PELL PAVILION - AMBULANCE BAY - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 9:04 AM

Ambulances roll in, one after another, lights spinning. LT. TANISHA "TEE" ROLLINS (28), FDNY EMS, tough, efficient, jumps down from the first rig with her partner ANDRE FONTAINE (27).

Elxa stands at the bay doors with a fistful of colored triage tags. Her interns line up behind her.

ELXA
Listen to me. Red tag: dying now. Yellow: dying later. Green: walking wounded. Black: we can't help them, so we don't try. You don't get emotional about the color. You put on the tag and you move.

TEE
(wheeling in the first stretcher)
Forty-four-year-old male, went over his handlebars into a guardrail post. GCS six. Left pupil sluggish. Helmet's cracked clean through.

ELXA
Red. Trauma 1. Neuro. Smilley, go with him.

Esther takes the head of the stretcher and runs.

ANDRE
(second stretcher)
Sixty-seven-year-old male, belly's rigid, pressure ninety over fifty and falling. Says he's fine. He is not fine.

ELXA
Red. Trauma 3. Baker, you're with me.

The ambulances keep coming. Arianna steps up to the next one before Elxa can assign her, takes a quick look at the rider (scraped, alert, holding her own wrist) and slaps on a tag.

ARIANNA
Green. Broken wrist, she's talking, she's fine. (to the next one) Yellow. Open tib-fib, pulses intact. (to the next one) Hey. HEY. Look at me. What's your name? (no answer) Red. He's not tracking.

Elxa watches her for a beat. Arianna is fast, decisive, completely in her element.

ELXA
(grudging)
Cummings. Keep doing that.

ARIANNA
(not looking up)
Doing what? This is just Thursday in Gary.

8 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 1 - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 9:09 AM

Curtis Roberts lies intubated on the trauma table, unmoving. DR. LELAND GRAVES (52) shines a penlight into his eyes. Esther squeezes the bag. A RESPIRATORY THERAPIST stands by.

GRAVES
Left pupil five millimeters, nonreactive. Right is three and sluggish. He's herniating. CT, now, and book OR 1. Mannitol, one gram per kilo.

ESTHER
Mannitol, one gram per kilo.

Through the glass, Esther sees Marc in the hallway with a girl in a yellow jersey, her helmet still on, trying to push past a nurse to get into the room.

NIA (O.S.)
That's my daddy! That's my DADDY!

Marc kneels down in front of her in the hallway.

9 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - HALLWAY OUTSIDE TRAUMA 1 - CONTINUOUS
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 9:10 AM

Nia is shaking. She has a scraped elbow and a green tag on her wrist. Marc kneels so he's below her eye level.

MARC
Hey. Hey. What's your name?

NIA
Nia. Nia Roberts. That's my daddy in there. Curtis Roberts. He's... his head...

MARC
I know. The best brain surgeon in New York is in there with him right now. Dr. Graves. He's grumpy, and he's a genius.

NIA
I want to see him.

MARC
You can't go in right now. They need all the room to help him. But I'm going to stay right here with you. Is that okay? Can I stay with you?

Nia looks at him. At the door. Back at him. She nods, barely.

MARC
Can I take your helmet off? You've been wearing it a while.

She lets him unbuckle it. Underneath, her hair is in two puffs, crushed flat. He sets the helmet on a chair like it's precious.

NIA
(small)
I hit the bump. On the bridge. I hit the bump and I wobbled and then everybody fell.

MARC
(gently)
Nia, a lot of people fell today. That's a bridge problem. Not a Nia problem.

NIA
You don't know that.

MARC
(beat)
You're right. I don't know that yet. But I'm going to find out.

10 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 3 - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 9:14 AM

Deacon Hightower, pale and sweating but sharp-eyed, on the table. Elxa does an ultrasound of his belly. Amond reads the monitor. DR. ROBERT BULLOCK (49) comes in pulling on a

gown.

ELXA
Free fluid in the left upper quadrant. Splenic laceration. He's bleeding into his belly.

ROBERT
Pressure?

AMOND
Eighty-six over fifty. Heart rate one twenty-two.

ROBERT
Type and cross four units. We're going to the OR.

HIGHTOWER
(firm, quiet)
No blood.

Everyone stops.

HIGHTOWER
Check my wallet. Left pocket.

A NURSE pulls a card from his cycling jersey pocket and reads it.

NURSE
"Advance medical directive. No blood. I am one of Jehovah's Witnesses. I refuse whole blood, red cells, white cells, plasma and platelets under any circumstances, even if doctors believe my life is at risk."

AMOND
Sir, you're bleeding to death. Without a transfusion you could...

HIGHTOWER
(looking at him with complete calm)
Young man. I've been carrying that card since 1961. I knew what it meant when I signed it. I know what it means now.

AMOND
(to Robert)
He's in shock. He can't make that decision.

ROBERT
(examining Hightower's eyes)
Mr. Hightower. What day is it?

HIGHTOWER
Sunday, July seventeenth. I'm on the Queensboro Bridge, or I was. Your name tag says Bullock. Your young man's says Baker. And he's upset with me.

ROBERT
(beat)
He's competent. (to Elxa)
Bloodless protocol. Call perfusion for a cell saver. Ask him about it, because some patients accept it and some don't. Aprotinin. And we move fast, because every drop he loses is a drop we can't give back.

AMOND
Dr. Bullock...

ROBERT
Dr. Baker. His body. His faith. His choice. Our job is to be good enough that his choice doesn't kill him. Scrub.

11 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - HALLWAY BED 9 - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 9:21 AM

The hallway is lined with gurneys now. Harmony is with a young male rider, KEVIN AMOS (24), who's struggling to breathe, his lips going dusky. Gloria passes, sees it and stops dead.

HARMONY
His sats are eighty-four. Breath sounds are... I can't hear anything on the right.

GLORIA
Trachea?

Harmony looks at Kevin's neck. His trachea is pushed to the left.

HARMONY
Deviated left.

GLORIA
Then what's he got, Doctor?

HARMONY
(realizing)
Tension pneumothorax. He needs a chest tube. I need to find a resident...

GLORIA
Every resident in this building is elbow-deep in somebody. He needs it now. (handing her a large-bore needle) Second intercostal space, midclavicular line. Over the top of the rib. You've seen it done?

HARMONY
In a book. On a dummy. Once.

GLORIA
(calm and absolute)
Then today's the day it's real. I'll be right here.

Harmony looks at the needle. At Kevin, gasping. Her hand shakes for one second... then steadies.

She finds the space. She pushes the needle in over the top of the rib. A loud HISS of escaping air. Kevin takes a huge, ragged breath.

KEVIN
(gasping)
Oh... oh, God...

GLORIA
(watching the monitor)
Ninety. Ninety-three. Ninety-six. (to Harmony) That's what it sounds like when you save a life, baby. Remember that sound.

Harmony stares at the needle in her hand. She's not shaking.

12 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - BAY 12 - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 9:33 AM

DeMarco Whitley lies on a gurney with his right thigh splinted, his face gray with pain but his jaw set. Raven reviews the X-ray. A complete midshaft femur fracture.

DEMARCO
How long?

RAVEN
For what?

DEMARCO
Till I ride.

RAVEN
Mr. Whitley, your femur is broken in half. It's the strongest bone in your body. You broke it in half.

DEMARCO
The Olympic trials for Beijing are in 2008. I've been training for nine years. I'm the best road cyclist in New York State. How long?

RAVEN
(gently)
Ortho will put a rod in it. Months of rehab. And then... I don't know.

DEMARCO
(beat, staring at the ceiling)
I was pacing. I was supposed to be pacing them across the bridge. Some kid went down behind me, and I heard it, and I turned around, and then I was on the ground.

Raven looks at his leg. Frowns. She presses gently on his calf below the splint. He yells.

RAVEN
How much does that hurt? One to ten.

DEMARCO
(through his teeth)
Fifteen.

RAVEN
More than the break?

DEMARCO
Way more than the break.

Raven's face changes. She grabs the chart.

RAVEN
(to herself)
Pain out of proportion.

13 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRIAGE AREA - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 9:41 AM

Darnell Hicks sits on a gurney with a gash on his forehead and road rash down one arm. Two older RIDERS in torn jerseys stand over him, furious.

RIDER 1
That's him! He's the one who went down first! He didn't have no business on that bridge! Look at him, in sneakers!

RIDER 2
You know how many people are hurt because of you?

Darnell can't look up. Arianna steps between them with a suture tray.

ARIANNA
Hey. Back up. Both of you.

RIDER 1
He caused it!

ARIANNA
And you've got a sprained wrist and a big mouth. Go get your wrist X-rayed. (to Rider 2) And you go sit down before I find something on you that needs a rectal exam.

The riders retreat. Arianna sits on a stool, opens the suture kit and starts cleaning Darnell's forehead.

ARIANNA
You okay?

DARNELL
(barely audible)
Is the man okay? The one who hit the post?

ARIANNA
I don't know.

DARNELL
It's my fault.

ARIANNA
(beat)
What happened up there?

Darnell doesn't answer. He looks at the photo still taped to his broken handlebars, propped against the wall. "FOR GRANDMA ROSE."

14 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - HALLWAY OUTSIDE TRAUMA 1 - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 9:47 AM

Marc and Nia sit side by side on two plastic chairs. She drinks apple juice from a little carton. He's drawn a tic-tac-toe grid on the back of a triage tag, and they've been playing. She's winning.

NIA
You keep going in the corner. You're bad at this.

MARC
I'm letting you win.

NIA
You're not. You're just bad.

MARC
(grinning)
I'm a little bad.

The doors to Trauma 1 BANG open. Graves, Esther and a nurse wheel Curtis out at speed toward the elevators, the RT bagging him. He's covered in tubes. Unrecognizable.

GRAVES
(moving fast)
OR 1! Now! Tell them we're coming!

Nia drops the juice. She stands. Marc stands with her, a hand on her shoulder.

NIA
Daddy!

Esther meets Marc's eyes over the stretcher for half a second as she passes. It tells him everything. It's bad.

The elevator doors close. Nia turns to Marc, her face crumpling.

NIA
Is he going to die?

Marc opens his mouth. Nothing comes out.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

15 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - HALLWAY OUTSIDE TRAUMA 1 - CONTINUOUS
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 9:48 AM

Nia is still staring at him. Waiting.

MARC
(carefully, kneeling again)
Nia. I'm not going to lie to you, because I don't lie to the people I'm taking care of. Your daddy is very, very hurt. His brain is swelling from where he hit his head. Dr. Graves is going to operate to give his brain room.

NIA
Is he going to die?

MARC
I don't know. That's the truth. I don't know yet. (beat) But nobody's giving up on him. And I'm not leaving you. Where's your mom?

NIA
Philadelphia. At Aunt Bea's. Aunt Bea has sickle cell. That's why we were riding.

MARC
Do you know her number?

Nia recites it from memory, without hesitating. Marc writes it on his hand in pen.

MARC
That's a very good memory.

NIA
My daddy made me learn it. In case of emergency.

16 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRIAGE AREA - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 9:56 AM

Elxa moves through the triage area, assigning, checking tags, giving orders. Someone opens a bottle of

lemon-scented disinfectant nearby. Elxa stops mid-sentence. She sways.

Arianna, passing with a suture tray, catches her by the elbow before her knees fully buckle, and steers her onto an empty gurney. Smoothly. No one else notices.

ARIANNA
Sit.

ELXA
(furious, dizzy)
Get your hand off me, Cummings.

ARIANNA
(handing her a cup of water)
Drink this. Put your head down for ten seconds. Then you can yell at me.

Elxa, against every instinct, drinks. Puts her head down. Arianna stands so her body blocks Elxa from the rest of the room.

ARIANNA
(low)
When are you due?

Elxa's head snaps up.

ELXA
Excuse me?

ARIANNA
My mama was pregnant six times. Saltines at five in the morning. Ginger ale. You smell lemon and turn green. (beat) When are you due?

A long, dangerous silence.

ELXA
(very quietly)
February.

ARIANNA
Does anybody know?

ELXA
My husband. My mother. My sister. And now you. (standing, color back in her face) If you tell anyone, Cummings, I swear on everything holy, you'll be doing rectal exams on this floor until 2012.

ARIANNA
(shrugging)
I'm not a snitch. I'm from Gary.

Elxa looks at her. Something between them shifts.

ELXA
(grudging)
...Thank you.

ARIANNA
Don't get weird, Warden. Go cut something.

17 INT. PELL PAVILION - OR 2 - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 10:18 AM

Hightower is open on the table. Robert operates, Elxa first-assisting, Amond retracting. A PERFUSIONIST runs a cell saver machine connected in a continuous loop to the patient. No blood bags hang anywhere.

ROBERT
He agreed to the cell saver, as long as the circuit stays continuous with his body. His blood never leaves him. That's his line, so that's ours. (beat) Suction.

The spleen is shattered. Robert works fast and precisely, clamping the vessels.

ROBERT
Splenic artery. Clamp. Splenic vein. Clamp. Short gastrics. Fast, Elxa, fast.

ELXA
Got it.

Amond watches the anesthesia monitor. His voice is tight.

AMOND
Hemoglobin's six-point-one.

ROBERT
I know.

AMOND
If this were any other patient, we'd be hanging two units right now.

ROBERT
It's not any other patient. Retract.

The spleen comes out. Robert drops it in a basin.

ROBERT
Bleeding is controlled. Now we see what his body can do on what's left.

Amond stares at the hemoglobin number: 5.9.

AMOND
(to himself)
This is insane.

ROBERT
(without looking up)
No, Dr. Baker. This is medicine with a conscience you don't share. Learn the difference. You'll need it.

18 INT. OLD MAIN - RESIDENTS' LOUNGE - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 10:44 AM

A two-minute break. Harmony and Raven chug water. The TV is on NY1.

ON THE TV: NY1 LIVE. A helicopter shot of the Queensboro Bridge: the lower roadway strewn with bikes, ambulances and police cars. The banner reads: "BREAKING: CHARITY RIDE PILEUP ON QUEENSBORO BRIDGE. DOZENS INJURED. MOST TAKEN TO QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL."

NY1 REPORTER (ON TV)
...organizers say the 'Queens Century for the Cure' raises money for sickle cell research. Police say a rider apparently went down near an expansion joint, triggering a chain reaction among dozens of cyclists...

RAVEN
Sickle cell. They were riding for sickle cell.

HARMONY
(staring at her hands)
I put a needle in a man's chest.

RAVEN
What?

HARMONY
Tension pneumothorax. There was no resident. Gloria gave me the needle and said, "Today's the day it's real." And I did it. And he breathed. (beat) Raven, I heard the air come out. It went HISSSS. Like a tire.

RAVEN
(grabbing her arm)
Harmony! That's amazing!

HARMONY
I didn't freeze.

RAVEN
You didn't freeze!

They hold each other's forearms and do a tiny, silent scream of joy. Then Raven's face changes.

RAVEN
I think my guy has compartment syndrome.

HARMONY
Which guy?

RAVEN
The Olympic one. His pain is way out of proportion to the fracture. I need to get pressures.

19 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - BAY 12 - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 11:03 AM

An ORTHOPEDIC RESIDENT, DR. TERRELL BOYCE (33), reads a pressure monitor whose needle is inserted into DeMarco's calf. Raven watches. DeMarco grips the bed rails.

DR. BOYCE
Anterior compartment, fifty-two. Diastolic's seventy. Delta P is eighteen. He's got compartment syndrome. (to Raven) Good catch, Ellison. We need a fasciotomy, now, before the muscle dies.

DEMARCO
What does that mean?

RAVEN
The muscles in your lower leg are swelling inside a tight wrapper of tissue, and the pressure's crushing the blood vessels. If we don't release it, the muscle dies. Maybe the whole leg.

DEMARCO
Release it how?

DR. BOYCE
Two long incisions down your calf to open the compartments. We leave them open for a few days. Then skin grafts.

DEMARCO
(going pale)
Long incisions. In my leg. My racing leg.

RAVEN
(taking his hand)
Mr. Whitley. Your leg is not going to race again if it dies. This is how we keep it.

DeMarco looks at her. Then at the ceiling. He nods.

DEMARCO
(barely audible)
Nine years.

RAVEN
I know.

DEMARCO
You don't. Nobody knows. (beat)
Do it.

20 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRIAGE AREA - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 11:20 AM

Arianna finishes the last suture in Darnell's forehead and ties it off. He still hasn't looked up.

ARIANNA
Twelve stitches. You'll have a scar. Chicks dig scars, or so I'm told.

DARNELL
I didn't even have real shoes. My cousin lent me his bike. I signed up because my grandma has sickle cell. They said "all riders welcome." I'd never ridden over a bridge before.

ARIANNA
So what happened?

A long pause.

DARNELL
There was a little girl. In front of me. In the yellow jersey with puffs in her hair. Her front tire hit the joint and she started wobbling, like she was gonna go down right into the pack. If she went down there, everybody would've rolled right over her.

ARIANNA
(very still)
So you...

DARNELL
I swerved. I didn't think about it. I just went left. And my bike was too big, and I went down, and then... (his voice breaks)
...then everybody did. Because of me.

Arianna stares at him. Then she looks across the Pit... at Nia, sitting in the hallway with Marc, holding a juice box.

ARIANNA
The little girl. Two puffs. Yellow jersey. Braces?

DARNELL
(looking up for the first time)
You know her? Is she okay?

ARIANNA
She's okay. (beat) She's okay because of you.

21 INT. PELL PAVILION - FAMILY CONSULTATION ROOM - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 11:41 AM

A small room with a couch, a box of tissues and a print of a lighthouse. Marc sits with Nia. He's on the room's wall phone, his notes in pen on his hand.

MARC
(into the phone)
Mrs. Roberts, my name is Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock, at Queens Grace Hospital in Queens. Nia is right here with me. She's okay. She has a scrape on her elbow, and that's all. (beat) Yes, ma'am. (beat) Your husband was hurt in the crash on the bridge. He has a serious head injury, and he's in surgery right now.

We hear YOLANDA ROBERTS (40) on the other end through the receiver: a sound, then another, then a voice trying to hold itself together.

MARC
(gently)
I know. I know. The surgeon is the Chief of Neurosurgery. (beat) Yes. Come. I'll be here. I'll be with Nia the whole time until you get here. (beat) Two hours? Okay. Drive safe. Please drive safe. She needs you to drive safe.

He hangs up. Nia is watching him.

NIA
Was she crying?

MARC
Yeah.

NIA
(small)
She doesn't cry. Not even at movies.

MARC
Sometimes people who don't cry at movies cry at real things. That means the real things matter.

Nia pulls her knees up to her chest, in her yellow jersey.

NIA
Can we play tic-tac-toe again?

MARC
I'll get a fresh tag.

22 INT. PELL PAVILION - OR 1 - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 12:04 PM

Curtis Roberts's skull is open on the table. A large piece of bone has been removed and set aside. Graves operates under the microscope. Esther assists, suctioning. The room is quiet in the specific way ORs get quiet when things are going badly.

GRAVES
Decompressive craniectomy done. Evacuated the subdural. But look at the brain, Smilley. What do you see?

ESTHER
(looking through the scope)
It's swollen. It's pushing out through the defect even with the bone off. It's... it's dusky.

GRAVES
Diffuse axonal injury, on top of herniation. He hit that post at about twenty-five miles an hour with his head as the leading point. The helmet split. The brain kept moving inside the skull after his head stopped.

ESTHER
(beat)
Is he going to wake up?

Graves doesn't answer right away. He's been doing this for thirty years. He looks at the monitor. At the brain. At Esther.

GRAVES
(quietly)
No. He's not going to wake up.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

23 INT. PELL PAVILION - OR 1 SCRUB ROOM - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 12:31 PM

Graves and Esther wash at the long sink. Through the window, the nurses are closing the scalp. Esther scrubs her hands long past clean, like Harmony did two weeks ago.

GRAVES
We'll keep him on the ventilator in the neuro ICU. When the sedation clears, I'll do a formal brain death examination. Then the apnea test. If he meets criteria, he's legally dead in the state of New York. The heart will still beat for a while. But Curtis Roberts will be gone.

ESTHER
He has a twelve-year-old daughter. She's sitting in the family room with Marc playing tic-tac-toe.

GRAVES
I know.

ESTHER
How do you... how do you do this? Every time?

Graves turns off the water. Dries his hands.

GRAVES
You don't do it every time. Every time does it to you. And then you come back in the morning anyway. (beat) Smilley. When we're sure, and only when we're sure, the New York Organ Donor Network will be called. That's the law. If he's a donor, that man's heart could be beating in someone else by tomorrow.

ESTHER
You're thinking about his organs.

GRAVES
I'm thinking about the only good thing that might happen today. Somebody in this building has to.

24 INT. PELL PAVILION - CORRIDOR OUTSIDE FAMILY ROOM - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 12:44 PM

Marc comes out of the family room to get juice. Esther is standing there, still in her surgical cap. One look at her face and he knows.

MARC
(quiet)
No.

ESTHER
He's not going to wake up. Graves will do the brain death exam when the sedation's out of his system. Tonight, probably.

Marc leans against the wall. Closes his eyes.

MARC
She knows her mom's number by heart. He made her learn it for emergencies.

ESTHER
(beat)
You can't tell her.

MARC
I know. Her mom has to be the one. I know.

ESTHER
Her mom's two hours away. You're going to have to sit in that room with her for two hours and not tell her.

MARC
(opening his eyes)
Yeah.

Esther reaches out and puts her hand on his arm. Just for a second. He looks at it.

ESTHER
I'll get the juice. Go back in. She shouldn't be alone.

25 INT. PELL PAVILION - SURGICAL ICU - BED 7 - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 1:12 PM

Hightower lies post-op, pale as paper but awake, an oxygen mask on his face. The monitor shows a heart rate of 118. Amond reads the lab printout. Robert stands at the foot of the bed.

AMOND
Hemoglobin's five-point-two. Normal is fourteen. He's tachycardic, his heart's working overtime to push what's left of his blood around. If he drops much lower, his heart can't keep up. The heart muscle starts to starve. Infarct.

HIGHTOWER
(weakly, through the mask)
Young man. I can hear you.

AMOND
(turning to him)
Then hear this, sir, with respect. You need two units of blood. Two little bags. And you will very likely walk out of here in a week. Without them, you might not walk out at all.

HIGHTOWER
(calm)
And if I take them, I walk out without my faith. What's a man without his faith, Doctor? A body. Just a body.

AMOND
A body that's alive.

HIGHTOWER
(almost smiling)
You sound like my son.

Robert takes Amond by the elbow and leads him a few steps away.

ROBERT
(low)
You've said it. He's heard it. You've done your job. Say it again and it becomes coercion.

AMOND
He's going to die of a choice.

ROBERT
Possibly. And it's his choice. (beat) So now we do everything else. IV iron. High-dose erythropoietin to push his marrow. Oxygen. We minimize blood draws: pediatric tubes, labs only when they change what we do. We lower his metabolic demand. Keep him still, cool, calm.

AMOND
Will that work?

ROBERT
Sometimes. (beat) Baker. Ninety percent of this job is doing everything right and accepting that it might not be enough. The other ten percent is miracles, and you don't get to schedule those.

26 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - HALLWAY BED 9 - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 1:30 PM

Kevin Amos, the tension pneumothorax, now with a proper chest tube in place, sits up on his gurney eating a pudding cup. Harmony checks his drainage.

KEVIN
You're the one who stabbed me.

HARMONY
Needle-decompressed you.

KEVIN
You stabbed me, and I could breathe again. It's the best thing anybody's ever done to me. (beat) I'm going to name my firstborn after you.

HARMONY
(laughing)
You don't even know my name.

KEVIN
(reading her badge)
Harmony Divine. (beat) Oh, that's a great name. That's a gospel singer's name.

HARMONY
I'm in the choir.

KEVIN
Of course you are.

Gloria passes and doesn't stop, but she says it over her shoulder:

GLORIA
Nice work today, Divine. You were a real doctor.

Harmony stands there, stunned and glowing.

27 INT. PELL PAVILION - ORTHO OR - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 1:52 PM

DeMarco's leg is on the table, the femur already rodded. Dr. Boyce makes long, deliberate fasciotomy incisions down the calf. Swollen muscle bulges out. Raven, gowned, holds a retractor.

DR. BOYCE
See the color? Pink. Still viable. You caught it in time, Ellison. Two more hours and this would've been gray. Dead.

RAVEN
(staring at the muscle)
He's going to have scars from his knee to his ankle.

DR. BOYCE
He's going to have a leg from his knee to his ankle. That's the trade.

28 INT. PELL PAVILION - FAMILY CONSULTATION ROOM - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 2:20 PM

Hours in. A pile of used triage tags covered in tic-tac-toe games. Nia, exhausted, lies with her head on the arm of the couch. Marc sits on the floor beside her, reading her a pamphlet about the hospital's history, doing voices.

MARC
(reading, dramatic)
"...and so, in 1909, the Queensboro Bridge opened, and Queens Grace became the bridge's hospital..."

NIA
(drowsy)
That's so boring.

MARC
It's extremely boring. I'm reading it so you'll sleep.

NIA
Is it working?

MARC
Your eyes are closing.

NIA
(eyes closing)
Dr. Bullock?

MARC
Yeah?

NIA
Was it my fault? The bump?

Before Marc can answer, there's a soft knock. Arianna stands in the doorway. She looks at Nia, then at Marc, then jerks her head toward the hall.

29 INT. PELL PAVILION - CORRIDOR OUTSIDE FAMILY ROOM - CONTINUOUS
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 2:22 PM

ARIANNA
(low)
The kid who went down first, the one everybody's blaming. Darnell. He went down because he swerved to keep from running her over. She hit the expansion joint, she started wobbling into the pack, and he cut left and ate the pavement so the whole pack wouldn't roll right over her.

Marc stares at her.

MARC
He took the fall for her.

ARIANNA
On purpose. On a borrowed bike, in sneakers. And now half the riders in the Pit want him arrested, and he thinks he killed her dad.

Marc looks back through the window at Nia, asleep on the couch.

MARC
She asked me if it was her fault.

ARIANNA
(beat)
What'd you tell her?

MARC
Nothing yet. She fell asleep.

ARIANNA
(shrugging, uncomfortable with her own decency)
Well. Now you know. It was a bridge problem. And a kid who was brave.

She walks away fast before he can thank her.

30 INT. OLD MAIN - INTERNS' LOCKER ROOM - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 2:40 PM

A rare five-minute break. Raven sits on the bench in fresh scrubs, eating a granola bar. Harmony re-ties her headscarf in the mirror. Esther comes in, still in her OR

cap, and sits down heavily without a word.

HARMONY
(turning)
Esther?

ESTHER
Curtis Roberts isn't going to wake up.

Raven puts down the granola bar. Harmony comes and sits on Esther's other side. Neither says anything. They just sit with her, shoulder to shoulder, on a bench in a locker room that smells like disinfectant.

ESTHER
(quiet)
I held the suction while Graves took off half his skull. And the whole time I was thinking about his daughter out there playing tic-tac-toe with Marc. I couldn't stop thinking about her.

RAVEN
That's not a bad thing to think about.

ESTHER
It is in the OR. You're supposed to think about the brain.

HARMONY
(gently)
My pastor says you can only carry somebody's grief if you let some of it in first. Maybe that's what the thinking was.

Esther leans her head back against the locker and closes her eyes. Her hand drifts to her collarbone, to the chain under her scrubs, and holds it. Raven notices.

RAVEN
What's on the chain? You always touch it when you're sad.

Esther's eyes open.

ESTHER
(beat, too smooth)
My grandmother's ring. She passed. I keep it close.

RAVEN
(softly)
That's beautiful.

Esther nods and doesn't look at either of them. Harmony, who grew up in a house with three generations of women who lied to protect each other, looks at her a beat longer than Raven does.

HARMONY
(standing, holding out a hand)
Come on. There are still forty people out there who need us.

Esther takes the hand.

31 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - FRONT ENTRANCE - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 2:58 PM

The doors open. Yolanda Roberts, still in the church clothes she was wearing in Philadelphia, rushes in, frantic, looking at every face. Marc steps forward to meet her.

MARC
Mrs. Roberts? I'm Dr. Bullock. I called you.

YOLANDA
Where is she? Where's my baby? Where's Curtis?

MARC
Nia's sleeping, right in the next room. She's okay. (beat) Dr. Graves would like to speak with you about your husband. Right in here.

He leads her into a small room off the corridor. Graves and Esther are waiting. Yolanda sees their faces. She stops in the doorway.

YOLANDA
(whispering)
No.

GRAVES
(gently)
Mrs. Roberts, please sit down.

YOLANDA
No. No, no, no. Don't you sit me down. You tell me standing.

Graves takes a breath. Esther stands just behind him, steady.

GRAVES
Mrs. Roberts. Your husband hit his head very hard. The injury to his brain is severe and widespread. We operated to relieve the pressure, but the damage is too much. He's on a ventilator. I'm so sorry. Curtis is not going to wake up.

A sound comes out of Yolanda that isn't a word.

In the next room, through the glass of the family room, Nia sits up on the couch. She can see her mother through the window. She sees her mother's face. She sees her mother's knees give way, and Marc catching her.

Nia doesn't need anyone to tell her.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

32 INT. PELL PAVILION - FAMILY CONSULTATION ROOM - DAY
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 3:14 PM

Yolanda sits on the couch with Nia wrapped in her arms, both of them crying. Marc sits on the floor nearby, giving them space but not leaving. The pile of tic-tac-toe tags is still on the table.

NIA
(muffled)
I hit the bump, Mama. I hit the bump and everybody fell.

YOLANDA
(rocking her)
Hush, baby. Hush.

MARC
(gently)
Nia. Can I tell you something I found out today?

Nia lifts her face out of her mother's shoulder.

MARC
When your tire hit the bump and you wobbled, there was a boy behind you. His name is Darnell. He was riding for his grandma, who has sickle cell, like your Aunt Bea. He saw you wobbling, and he knew if you fell, the whole pack would roll right over you.

NIA
(sniffling)
What did he do?

MARC
He swerved. On purpose. He threw his own bike down so the pack would hit him instead of you.

Yolanda looks at Marc over her daughter's head.

MARC
The bridge has a bump on it that shouldn't be there. That's the bridge's fault. A whole lot of people were riding close together. That's nobody's fault. And a boy you never met decided you were worth falling for. (beat) None of that is your fault, Nia. None of it.

NIA
(quiet)
Daddy held my hand at the start line. He said, "Twenty-five miles, then you cheer for me at the finish."

YOLANDA
(breaking)
Oh, Curtis.

Marc looks down. Then he picks up a fresh triage tag from the table, draws a tic-tac-toe grid on the back and sets it gently on the cushion beside Nia. She looks at it. She takes the pen. She puts an X in the corner.

NIA
(whispering, through tears)
You always go in the corner.

MARC
(whispering back)
I know. I'm bad at it.

33 INT. PELL PAVILION - NEURO ICU - FAMILY ALCOVE - NIGHT
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 7:46 PM

Curtis lies in the ICU bed beyond the glass, ventilator breathing for him, his head bandaged. Graves has completed the brain death examination. A woman in a navy blazer with a lanyard, PAMELA GAITHER-HALL (44), Family Services Coordinator from the New York Organ Donor Network, sits with Yolanda. Esther stands nearby.

PAMELA
Mrs. Roberts, I'm so sorry for your loss. Dr. Graves has determined that Curtis has died. I'm here because Curtis registered as an organ donor. It's on his driver's license. He signed up at the DMV in 2002.

YOLANDA
(staring through the glass)
He signed up the day his sister got her diagnosis. Bea. Sickle cell. He said, "If I can't fix her blood, I can fix somebody."

PAMELA
His heart, his kidneys, his liver and his corneas could help as many as eight people. You don't have to decide anything right now.

YOLANDA
(beat)
He already decided.

She stands and walks to the glass. Puts her palm flat against it.

YOLANDA
You hear me, Curtis? You stubborn man. You're still riding.

Esther turns away so they can't see her face.

34 INT. PELL PAVILION - SURGICAL ICU - BED 7 - NIGHT
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 8:22 PM

Hightower, grayer now, monitors chiming. A young man in a Mets cap is at the bedside: ANTHONY HIGHTOWER (35), his son, furious and desperate. Amond and Robert are at the foot of the bed. A COMPUTER ON WHEELS shows the hemoglobin: 4.8.

ANTHONY
He is DYING. You hear me? Four-point-eight! I looked it up on my BlackBerry in the parking garage. Give him the blood!

ROBERT
Mr. Hightower, your father is awake, alert and has capacity. He has refused blood products consistently, before and after surgery.

ANTHONY
I'm his son! I'm not a Witness! I left that church when I was eighteen! I'm his health care proxy!

ROBERT
A proxy only decides when the patient can't. Your father can.

Anthony turns to his father.

ANTHONY
Pop. Please. Please. For me. For Junior and Kayla. They want their grandpa at their graduations.

Hightower reaches out a trembling hand and takes his son's.

HIGHTOWER
Anthony. You left the church. You didn't leave me. I never asked you to believe what I believe. I'm asking you to let me die believing it, if that's what God wants.

ANTHONY
(breaking)
God doesn't want you to die over two bags of blood!

HIGHTOWER
(softly)
Then I won't.

Amond watches the two of them, jaw clenched. He walks out. Robert watches him go.

35 INT. PELL PAVILION - CORRIDOR - NIGHT
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 8:31 PM

Amond paces the empty corridor. Robert catches up to him.

AMOND
He's going to die, and the thing that would save him is in a refrigerator one floor down. I could walk down there right now.

ROBERT
(very calmly)
And then you'd be a doctor who assaulted a patient. Because that's what it is, Dr. Baker. A transfusion without consent is battery, not heroism. There are surgeons who've lost their licenses for it. Some of them were right about the medicine. They were still wrong.

AMOND
How do you stand it?

ROBERT
You stand it by understanding that you are not the only person in the room whose values matter. (beat) My father drove a bus thirty-four years. He used to say, "My bus, my rules. Your life, your rules." I didn't understand that until I was forty.

Amond stops pacing.

AMOND
What's his pressure been doing?

ROBERT
(beat)
Holding. Heart rate's come down a little since the epo.

AMOND
(beat)
I'll sit with him tonight. I'll check his labs every six hours. Pediatric tubes. Minimum blood draws.

ROBERT
(the smallest nod)
Good.

36 INT. PELL PAVILION - FAMILY CONSULTATION ROOM - NIGHT
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 8:58 PM

Nia sits with her mother. A quiet knock. Arianna is in the doorway with Darnell, who has twelve stitches in his forehead and a bandaged arm, holding his broken handlebars with the photo still taped on: "FOR GRANDMA ROSE."

ARIANNA
(to Yolanda, uncharacteristically gentle)
Ma'am. Sorry to interrupt. This is Darnell. He wanted to... he asked if he could say something. You can say no.

Yolanda looks at him. The boy everybody's been blaming. She nods.

Darnell steps in. He can't look at Nia at first. Then he does.

DARNELL
I'm so sorry about your dad. I... I'm sorry.

Nia looks at him. At his stitches. At the photo on the handlebars.

NIA
You swerved. For me.

DARNELL
(shrugging, eyes filling)
You were wobbling. I didn't think about it.

Nia stands up. She walks over and hugs him around the waist. Darnell freezes, then puts his good arm around her, shoulders shaking.

Yolanda covers her mouth. Arianna, in the doorway, looks away fast, blinking hard.

37 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - FRONT ENTRANCE - NIGHT
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 9:04 PM

Darnell sits on a bench by the doors with his broken handlebars across his knees, waiting for a ride. The doors slide open. A home attendant pushes in a wheelchair carrying GRANDMA ROSE HICKS (71), frail, with an oxygen

cannula, a church hat and fire in her eyes.

ROSE
Darnell Anthony Hicks.

Darnell stands up so fast he almost drops the handlebars.

DARNELL
Grandma, you can't be out here, your lungs...

ROSE
My lungs got me here on the Q60 and a prayer. (holding out her arms) Come here.

He kneels and lets her hold his face in both hands. She looks at the stitches on his forehead.

ROSE
They told me on the news a boy went down so a little girl wouldn't. Then Pastor called and said, "Rose, that boy was yours."

DARNELL
(crying)
A man died, Grandma. People are saying it's my fault.

ROSE
People said a lot of things about a lot of good men. (beat) You rode a bridge for my blood, in your cousin's bike and your Payless sneakers. And when it came time, you fell for a child you didn't know. (her voice cracking) That's who I raised.

Arianna watches from the triage desk, a chart in her hands she isn't reading. Something in her face aches. Gary, Indiana. Nobody ever came through any door for her like that.

Kendra, passing, notices Arianna's face. She doesn't say anything. She just touches Arianna's arm as she goes by. Arianna lets her.

38 INT. PELL PAVILION - CORRIDOR - NIGHT
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 9:11 PM

Arianna steps out into the empty hallway and wipes her eyes quickly. Elxa comes around the corner and sees her.

ELXA
Cummings. Are you crying?

ARIANNA
Allergies.

ELXA
To what?

ARIANNA
Decent people.

Elxa almost smiles.

ELXA
You caught me today. In front of the whole Pit. Nobody saw.

ARIANNA
That was the point.

ELXA
Why?

ARIANNA
(beat)
You're the only resident who calls me Problem to my face instead of behind my back. I respect that. (beat) Also, somebody's gotta keep that baby alive, and you obviously aren't eating.

Elxa reaches into her pocket and pulls out a sleeve of saltines. Holds it up. Then pulls out another and tosses it to Arianna.

ELXA
You're still a problem.

ARIANNA
(catching it)
I know, Warden.

39 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - THE ROOF - NIGHT
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 10:04 PM

The skyline. Across the river, the Queensboro Bridge, its lower roadway cleaned and reopened, glitters with car

headlights again like nothing ever happened. Marc stands at the parapet, looking at it. Amond comes up and stands beside him.

AMOND
You won today.

MARC
(not turning)
My patient died.

AMOND
Your patient was always going to die. You got a twelve-year-old through the worst day of her life without lying to her once, and you found out the kid everybody hated was a hero. That's winning.

MARC
It doesn't feel like winning.

AMOND
It's not supposed to. (beat) My patient is choosing to die over two bags of blood, and I have to sit with him all night and respect it, and I hate it more than anything I've ever hated. That's losing. But it's right.

They stand there.

MARC
Winning a battle.

AMOND
Losing a war.

MARC
Is it always going to be like this?

AMOND
(beat)
Probably. (beat) We'll get better at it.

MARC
At winning?

AMOND
At standing on the roof after.

40 INT. PELL PAVILION - STAIRWELL C - NIGHT
SUNDAY, JULY 17, 2005 - 10:47 PM

A quiet concrete stairwell. Marc sits alone on the steps, elbows on his knees, finally letting it out: silent, shaking crying, the kind you do where nobody can see.

The door opens above. Footsteps. Natasha, in her white coat, coming down from the ninth floor. She sees him. She stops.

She looks up and down the stairwell. Empty. Then she sits down one step above him. Not touching. A Chief sitting on the stairs. Anyone who walked in would see exactly that.

NATASHA
(quietly)
Your first one?

MARC
(wiping his face)
It's not my first death. I had patients die at Hopkins.

NATASHA
It's your first one here. The first one in your own hospital is different.

MARC
He made her memorize her mom's phone number. In case of emergency.

Natasha closes her eyes for a moment.

NATASHA
My first one here was 1993. A twenty-six-year-old with an amniotic fluid embolism. She had twins. I delivered both of them. They lived. She didn't. (beat) I sat in this same stairwell. Third step from the bottom. I thought, maybe I'm not made for this.

MARC
What changed your mind?

NATASHA
Nothing changed my mind. I just came back the next morning. And the morning after that. (beat) The twins are twelve now. They send me a card every year. I keep every one.

Marc lets out a long breath. Without looking, Natasha reaches down, just once, and rests her hand on the back of his neck, the way she did when he was small. Two seconds. Then she takes it back and stands.

NATASHA
(Chief again)
Go home after your shift, Dr. Bullock. Sleep. That's an order.

MARC
Yes, Chief.

She climbs back up the stairs. At the landing, out of sight, she stops, puts her hand on the wall, and breathes.

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

41 INT. PELL PAVILION - SURGICAL ICU - BED 7 - NIGHT
MONDAY, JULY 18, 2005 - 4:02 AM

Pre-dawn. Anthony Hightower is asleep in the visitor's chair with his Mets cap over his face. Amond sits on a stool by the bed, his textbook closed on his knee, watching the monitor. A NURSE hands him a tiny pediatric blood tube's lab result. He reads it twice.

AMOND
(quiet)
Five-point-four.

Hightower opens his eyes.

HIGHTOWER
(weakly)
Is that good, Doctor?

AMOND
(beat)
It's up. From four-point-eight. Your marrow's responding to the epo and the iron. Your heart rate's down to ninety-eight.

HIGHTOWER
So I'm not dying.

AMOND
You're... dying less.

Hightower laughs, a weak wheeze, and pats Amond's hand.

HIGHTOWER
You sat up with me all night. A young man who thinks I'm a fool.

AMOND
I don't think you're a fool. (beat) I think you're braver than I am. I don't know what I believe in that much.

HIGHTOWER
You believe in that machine, and those numbers, and saving people. That's a faith, son. You're just not used to calling it one.

Amond looks at him.

HIGHTOWER
Faith and science. Sometimes they fight. And every once in a while, they shake hands.

In the chair, Anthony has woken up. He heard. He reaches over and takes his father's other hand.

42 INT. PELL PAVILION - OR 5 - NIGHT
MONDAY, JULY 18, 2005 - 4:40 AM

The organ recovery. A team from the New York Organ Donor Network works with quiet, ritual efficiency. Above, in the gallery, Esther sits alone in the front row, still in yesterday's scrubs.

Below, a surgeon lifts a heart into a sterile bag, into ice, into a red-and-white cooler labeled HUMAN ORGAN FOR TRANSPLANT. A coordinator reads from a clipboard.

COORDINATOR
Heart to NewYork-Presbyterian/Columbia. Fifteen-year-old female, dilated cardiomyopathy, status 1A. The team is wheels-up from the helipad in six minutes.

Amond appears in the gallery doorway, coming off his all-night vigil. He sits down next to Esther. They watch the cooler being wheeled out.

AMOND
(quiet)
A fifteen-year-old girl.

ESTHER
He signed up the day his sister got sick. "If I can't fix her blood, I can fix somebody."

Beat.

AMOND
My patient's hemoglobin is five-point-four.

ESTHER
Is that good?

AMOND
It's alive.

Through the gallery window, out across the dark, they can see the helicopter on the pad lifting off with the cooler aboard, banking toward Manhattan.

43 INT. PELL PAVILION - ORTHO STEP-DOWN - ROOM 7 - DAY
MONDAY, JULY 18, 2005 - 6:15 AM

Morning light. DeMarco lies with his leg in a massive dressing, the fasciotomy wounds left open under the bandages. Raven comes in with his chart and a cup of coffee from the cart. For him.

DEMARCO
(taking it)
Is this allowed?

RAVEN
Absolutely not.

He drinks.

RAVEN
Dr. Boyce says the muscle looks good. Pink. Alive. You'll get skin grafts on Thursday. Then months of PT. A lot of months. (beat) But you'll have your leg.

DEMARCO
(staring at the bandage)
Beijing is in 2008. The trials come before that. That's not even two years.

RAVEN
That's a long time.

DEMARCO
It's nothing. It's nothing for a femur and two holes in your calf.

RAVEN
(sitting down)
Then do it anyway. Train anyway. And if you don't make it, you'll know you didn't make it after trying. Not because you gave up in a hospital bed in Queens on a Monday.

DeMarco looks at her. Long.

DEMARCO
You're very annoying.

RAVEN
My grandma says it's my best quality.

DEMARCO
(beat, almost smiling)
If I get to the trials, will you come?

RAVEN
(beat)
If you get to the trials, I'll make a sign.

44 INT. PELL PAVILION - CHAPEL - DAY
MONDAY, JULY 18, 2005 - 7:03 AM

A small, quiet hospital chapel with stained glass, eight wooden pews and a candle rack. Marc sits in the third pew, post-call, still in scrubs. The door opens. Esther slides into the pew beside him.

ESTHER
I thought you'd be home asleep.

MARC
The Chief told me to go home and sleep. I came here instead. Technically I'm disobeying a direct order.

ESTHER
(sitting)
The heart went to a fifteen-year-old at Columbia.

Marc closes his eyes. Nods.

MARC
Nia's going to want to know that someday.

ESTHER
Someday she will.

They sit in silence. It's comfortable now in a way it wasn't a week ago.

ESTHER
You stayed with her for six hours. You never left that room.

MARC
Where was I going to go?

ESTHER
(looking at him)
Most people would have found somewhere.

Her phone vibrates in her scrub pocket. She takes it out and glances at the screen. The caller ID reads: CLAYTON.

Her face goes still. She presses DECLINE and puts the phone face down on the pew.

Marc saw it. He doesn't say anything for a moment.

MARC
(lightly)
Who's Clayton?

ESTHER
(too quickly)
Nobody. Someone from Boston.

MARC
Okay.

She looks at him. He's not pushing. He's just there. Somehow that's worse.

ESTHER
(standing)
I should go.

MARC
Esther.

She stops at the end of the pew.

MARC
Whoever he is. Whatever it is.
(beat) You're at my table now.
That doesn't change.

She looks at him for a long moment. Then she leaves without answering. The phone buzzes again on the pew where she left it. She comes back, grabs it and goes.

TAG

45 EXT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - STOOP - DAY
MONDAY, JULY 18, 2005 - 12:48 PM

Midday. Marc walks up 49th Avenue, wrecked. And sitting on his stoop, in sunglasses and a sundress, an ice-cold ginger ale beside her: Elxa. Off duty. Waiting.

MARC
(stopping)
What are you doing here? You're post-call.

ELXA
So are you. Sit.

He sits on the step below her. She hands him a sleeve of saltines.

ELXA
I'm only going to say this once, because I don't want you to get loud. Are you listening?

MARC
(wary)
I'm listening.

ELXA
I'm pregnant.

Marc stares at her.

ELXA
Nine and a half weeks. Due in February. You're the sixth person to know. Russell, Mom, Daddy, Grace, a problem from Gary, Indiana, and now you. (beat) Don't be weird.

A long silence. Marc's face is slowly, completely transforming.

ELXA
Marc. I said don't be...

Marc stands up, grabs his big sister and lifts her clean off the stoop into a bear hug, her feet dangling, her sunglasses going crooked.

ELXA
PUT ME DOWN. I'M PREGNANT.

MARC
(spinning her, laughing, crying)
I'm gonna be an UNCLE!

ELXA
THE WHOLE BLOCK CAN HEAR YOU!

MARC
(yelling to the street)
I'M GONNA BE AN UNCLE!

Up and down 49th Avenue, a few windows open. A NEIGHBOR on the next stoop, watering her plants, calls out:

NEIGHBOR
Congratulations, baby!

Elxa buries her face in his shoulder, laughing despite herself. And for the first time today, Marc-Anthony Bullock is happy.

MARC (V.O.)
They don't teach you this in medical school either.

MARC (V.O.)
That on the same day, in the same building, a man can die and a girl can get a heart. A father can be lost, and a stranger can be a hero. And a family can get a little bigger.

He sets her down. She straightens her sunglasses with enormous dignity.

ELXA
Rule one. Don't suck up. That includes to the baby.

MARC
(grinning)
I'm going to suck up to that baby so hard.

MARC (V.O.)
You can lose the war. You'll lose it a lot. But you don't stop showing up for the battles.

MARC (V.O.)
Because somewhere in the middle of all of them, life keeps happening. Whether you're ready for it or not.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 1x03

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

MySpace: bulletin from KeKe_SouthJamaica

Sunday, July 17, 2005, 7:30 AM

"MISS TEEN QUEENS 2005 recap!!! Destiny came in her wheelchair-that-she-didn't-need with her sign FRONT ROW RESERVED and the whole room clapped for her. She says next year she's answering the bus question and WINNING. also the tall doctor sent flowers?? who IS he." Comments (54)

NY1: BREAKING NEWS crawl

Sunday, July 17, 2005, 9:15 AM

"QUEENSBORO BRIDGE: MULTI-CYCLIST PILEUP DURING CHARITY RIDE ... LOWER ROADWAY CLOSED ... DOZENS HURT, SEVERAL CRITICAL ... MOST VICTIMS TAKEN TO QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL IN LONG ISLAND CITY ..."

MySpace: bulletin from HarmonyDivine_QNS

Sunday, July 17, 2005, 6:12 PM. Mood: amazed

"today i stuck a needle in a man's chest (MEDICALLY) and he could BREATHE. the head nurse said i was a real doctor. i am sitting in a supply closet crying for 30 seconds and then going back. pray for everybody from the bridge." Comments (19): *"THAT'S MY BABY!!!!! did u eat" (Lillian Divine)*

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Monday, July 18, 2005, 1:20 AM

"No jokes tonight, Queens. 43 riders came across that bridge to us today and every single one of them got a doctor. Somebody's dad didn't make it. His heart is going to a kid at Columbia in the morning. Tall Dimples sat with his little girl for six hours and never left the room. The Gary girl (yes, THAT one) caught a falling resident in the Pit and didn't tell a soul. The Q4 girl stabbed a man and saved him. The Bridge Rule held. Proud to work here. Back to gossip tomorrow." Comments (61).

NEW YORK DAILY NEWS: BRIDGE OF PAIN

Monday, July 18, 2005. "43 hurt, 1 dead as charity ride crashes on Queensboro"

The Queensboro Bridge's lower roadway reopened late yesterday after a pileup during the second annual Queens Century for the Cure, a 100-mile sickle cell fundraiser, left one rider dead and 42 others injured.

Curtis Roberts, 44, an MTA signal maintainer from South Jamaica, died of head injuries at Queens Grace Hospital. He was riding with his 12-year-old daughter, who was not seriously hurt.

Witnesses told the Daily News that a 19-year-old rider swerved to avoid the girl after her wheel caught a raised expansion joint, setting off a chain reaction. "That boy put himself on the ground for her," said one rider. A city Department of Transportation spokesman said the joint would be inspected.

Sidebar: Organizers have set up a memorial fund in Roberts's name for sickle cell research.

queenscentury.org (ride organizer website)

Monday, July 18, 2005, 9:00 AM

"IN MEMORY OF CURTIS ROBERTS, 1960-2005. Curtis rode 100 miles for his sister, Bea. His family asks that, in lieu of flowers, you register as an organ donor and donate to the Curtis Roberts Fund for Sickle Cell Research. Next year's ride will be dedicated to him, and to Darnell Hicks, who taught us all what riding for someone means."

NEW YORK AMSTERDAM NEWS: "Grandfather's Hands"

Thursday, July 21, 2005

HARLEM. When Keisha Freeland walked down the aisle at Abyssinian Baptist Church on Saturday, her grandfather, the retired Blue Note pianist Augustus Freeland, 74, played her in with "Lift Every Voice and Sing," nine days after awake brain surgery at Queens Grace Hospital to stop a 30-year tremor.

"I thought I'd never play for my baby again," Freeland said. "A young lady doctor sat by my head the whole time and told me to surprise her. So I did."

Continuity Sheet: Episode 1x03

New Canon Established

- **The Queensboro pileup** (Sunday, July 17, 2005, 8:42 AM): 43 riders injured and 1 killed (Curtis Roberts) during the Queens Century for the Cure, a sickle cell charity ride. Cause: Nia's wheel caught a raised expansion joint, and Darnell Hicks swerved to avoid her. The Bridge Rule held: QGH took the victims.
- **Arianna knows Elxa is pregnant** (she caught her at 9:56 AM and keeps the secret). Those who know: Russell, Natasha, Robert, Grace, Arianna and Marc (told on the stoop at 12:48 PM, July 18). She's due February 2006.
- Elxa and Arianna's bond has begun: shared saltines; 'You're still a problem.' / 'I know, Warden.'
- **Harmony's first solo save:** a needle decompression of a tension pneumothorax, guided by Gloria. Gloria: 'You were a real doctor.'
- **Raven's catch:** compartment syndrome in DeMarco Whitley. She promised to make a sign if he reaches the Olympic trials.
- **Amond's lesson:** Robert's 'My bus, my rules. Your life, your rules.' Amond sat with Deacon Hightower all night. Hightower: 'Faith and science... sometimes they shake hands.'
- **Esther told Raven and Harmony the ring on her chain is 'my grandmother's.'** Harmony doesn't fully believe it. **Esther:** a missed call from 'CLAYTON' at 7:03 AM on July 18. She told Marc it was 'someone from Boston.' Marc: 'You're at my table now.'
- **Natasha's first death at QGH** (1993): a 26-year-old mother lost to an amniotic fluid embolism. Her twins survived and are 12 now, and they send her a card every year. Stairwell C, third step from the bottom.
- Marc's neighbor on 49th Avenue now knows he's 'gonna be an uncle.'
- Curtis Roberts's heart went to a 15-year-old girl at NewYork-Presbyterian/Columbia. Nia knows her father 'is still riding.'

Knowledge Tracker

Secret	Knows	Doesn't know
Marc's identity	Family, Bernie, Graves (Gloria suspects)	All the interns, staff and patients
Elxa's pregnancy	Russell, Natasha, Robert, Grace, Arianna, Marc	Everyone else, including the program director
Arianna and Kendra	Raven	Everyone else
Esther's marriage	Esther (Marc has seen the name 'Clayton' and the ring chain, without context)	Everyone at QGH

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Curtis Roberts	8/30/1960 (44)	Severe TBI: subdural, herniation, diffuse axonal injury	Decompressive craniectomy (Graves; Esther)	Declared brain dead 7:46 PM, July 17. Organ donor (heart, kidneys, liver, corneas)
Wallace Hightower	1/12/1938 (67)	Splenic rupture; refuses blood (Jehovah's Witness)	Bloodless splenectomy with continuous-circuit cell saver (Robert; Elxa, Amond)	Hgb low of 4.8, then 5.4 on epo and IV iron. Survived
Kevin Amos	4/4/1981 (24)	Tension pneumothorax	Needle decompression (Harmony), then a chest tube	Stable
DeMarco Whitley	11/21/1973 (31)	Femur fracture; compartment syndrome	IM rod and four-compartment fasciotomy (Dr. Boyce; Raven)	Leg saved. Grafts Thursday
Darnell Hicks	5/1/1986 (19)	Forehead laceration, road rash	12 sutures (Arianna)	Discharged
Nia Roberts	2/9/1993 (12)	Elbow abrasion	Green tag (Marc)	Discharged with her mother

New Characters (to add to MA-005 and MA-006)

- **Lt. Tanisha 'Tee' Rollins** and **Andre Fontaine** (FDNY EMS) make their on-screen debut (already in MA-005).
- **Dr. Terrell Boyce**, b. September 9, 1971 (33). Orthopedic surgery resident. Recurring.
- **Nia Roberts** (b. February 9, 1993) and **Yolanda Roberts** (b. March 15, 1965). **Darnell Hicks** (b. May 1, 1986). **Wallace Hightower** and son **Anthony Hightower** (b. October 2, 1969). **DeMarco Whitley** (an Olympic-hopeful cyclist). **Rose Hicks** (b. March 22, 1934), Darnell's grandmother, who has sickle cell disease. **Kevin Amos**. **Pamela Gaither-Hall** (b. February 2, 1961), New York Organ Donor Network family services coordinator.

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- The Queensboro Bridge's lower roadway, its expansion joints and charity-ride closures are realistic. QGH's 'Bridge Rule' follows MA-008.
- Jehovah's Witness care: a refusal card, the patient's capacity overriding a non-Witness proxy, continuous-circuit cell salvage as a matter of individual conscience, erythropoietin and IV iron, and transfusion without consent as battery. All accurate.
- Brain death determination (clinical exam plus apnea test) and the New York Organ Donor Network's role are accurate for 2005. Compartment syndrome: pain out of proportion; delta pressure of 30 or less (here 18) indicates fasciotomy.
- The aprotinin reference is period-accurate for 2005; tranexamic acid's trauma use became standard after 2010.